

07 — User Management & RBAC

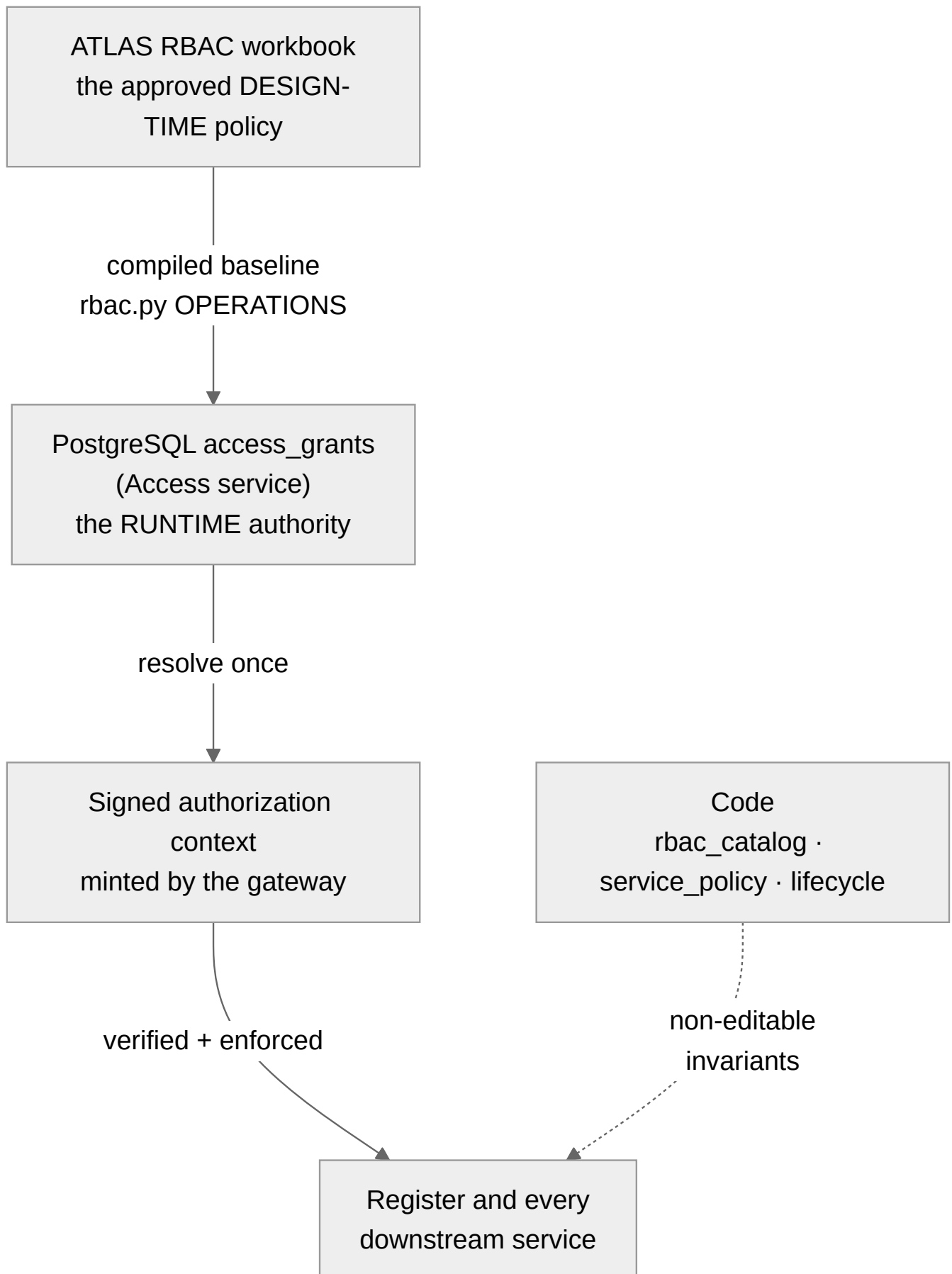
Audience: admins provisioning people; engineers touching authorization; security reviewers.

Companion docs: [03 Module interaction](#) · [11 ATLAS usage](#) · [08 Register](#) **Policy version:**

```
POLICY_VERSION = "3.8" ( packages/evam-backend-core/evam_backend_core/rbac_catalog.py )
```

1. The authority model — read this first

Three things decide what a person can do, and they are deliberately different things:



Layer	What it is	Changed by
Compiled baseline (<code>rbac.py</code>)	The approved workbook, transcribed into code	A reviewed pull request
<code>access_grants</code> in PostgreSQL	What actually decides a live request	Admin, through the governed API
Signed context	The per-request carrier of the resolved answer	Nothing — it is derived
Code invariants	Role catalogue, service-principal grants, lifecycle graph	A reviewed pull request only

`rbac.py`'s own header says it plainly: *"This file NEVER decides a production user request."* It exists to **seed** the runtime matrix, to produce a **drift report** (`python -m app.seed --check`), and for dev evaluation where no signed context exists.

This split is what lets an Admin widen someone's access at 4pm without a deploy, while keeping the things that must not be editable at runtime — which roles exist, what a machine may do, which stage moves are legal — in reviewed code.

2. The twelve roles

`packages/evam-backend-core/evam_backend_core/rbac_catalog.py`:

```
ROLES: dict[str, dict[str, str]] = {
    "Admin":          {"tier": "Leadership", "vertical": "System"},
    "Management":     {"tier": "Leadership", "vertical": "All"},
    "BD Head":        {"tier": "Head",       "vertical": "BD"},
    "Credit Head":    {"tier": "Head",       "vertical": "Credit"},
    "Syn Head":        {"tier": "Head",       "vertical": "Syndication"},
    "AM Head":         {"tier": "Head",       "vertical": "Asset Monetisation"},
    "BDRM":           {"tier": "IC",         "vertical": "BD"},
    "Deal Analyst":    {"tier": "IC",         "vertical": "Credit"},
    "Syn RM":          {"tier": "IC",         "vertical": "Syndication"},
    "AM RM":           {"tier": "IC",         "vertical": "Asset Monetisation"},
    "LMS Operator":    {"tier": "IC",         "vertical": "Servicing"},
    "LMS Management": {"tier": "Head",       "vertical": "Servicing"},
}
```

Three tiers (Leadership / Head / IC) across six verticals. The LMS pair is a **maker-checker pair**: the Operator posts routine ledger and covenant events; LMS Management holds the hard-to-reverse verbs — booking approval, classification, closure, waiver authority.

Role stacking

A person may hold several roles. Access levels are an `IntEnum` ordered so that **stacking is** `max()` **across held roles**:

```
class Access(IntEnum):
    NONE = 0
    READ = 1
    SCOPED = 2 # read-write on rows in the user's own scope
    FULL = 3   # read + write, no scope restriction within the module
    APPROVE = 4 # not a data write – an approve/reject decision
```

Renamed roles never strip access

```
ROLE_ALIASES: dict[str, str] = {"LMS Authorizer": "LMS Management"}
```

A role string stored before a rename — an `access_grants` row, a signed context minted by an older service, a decision's recorded roles — still resolves to the current role. New grants must use the current name.

Rank, as the UI uses it

The front-end mirror (`services/atlas/ui/src/auth/rbac.ts`) carries a numeric rank used for "is this a Head or above" decisions:

Rank	Roles
100	Admin
90	Management
70	BD Head, Credit Head, Syn Head, AM Head, LMS Management
40	BDRM, Deal Analyst, Syn RM, AM RM, LMS Operator

3. Two matrices: views and operations

The view matrix — "may this user open this screen?"

`services/atlas/ui/src/auth/rbac.ts` , and enforced server-side by Access.

	Adm	Mgmt	BDH	BDRM	CrH	DA	SynH	SynRM	AMH	AMRM	LMSO	LMSM
today	F	F	S	S	S	S	S	S	S	S	S	S
dash	F	F	S	N	S	N	S	N	S	N	N	N
leads	F	F	F	S	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N
deals	F	F	F	S	S	S	S	S	S	S	R	R
lend	F	F	R	R	F	S	R	R	R	R	R	R
syn	F	F	R	R	R	S	F	S	R	R	N	N
am	F	F	R	R	R	S	R	R	F	S	N	N
fi	F	F	R	R	R	R	F	R	R	R	N	N
clients	F	F	R	N	R	N	R	N	R	N	R	R
emp	F	F	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R
audit	F	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N
activity	F	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N
tools	F	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R

`F` full · `S` scoped · `R` read-only · `N` module hidden.

Two rows worth noticing:

- **leads is N for everyone below BD.** A Deal Analyst has no leads access at all. This produces a legitimate-looking oddity: *a Deal Analyst can own a lead they cannot see*. It is the matrix working as designed, not a bug.
- **audit and activity are Admin-only.** Not even Management.

The guiding principle from the workbook: **"Write follows the vertical, read follows the deal."**

The operations matrix — "may this user perform this verb?"

`packages/evam-backend-core/evam_backend_core/rbac.py::OPERATIONS`, ~70 operations. A sample of the shape:

```
OPERATIONS: dict[str, dict[str, Access]] = {
    "sign_in": _row("F F F F F F F F F F F"),
    "add_lead": _row("F F F F - - - - -"),
    "edit_lead": _row("F F F S - - - - -"),
    "push_lead_to_deals": _row("F F F S - - - - -"),
    "edit_client": _row("F F F S - - S S S - -"),
    ...
}
```

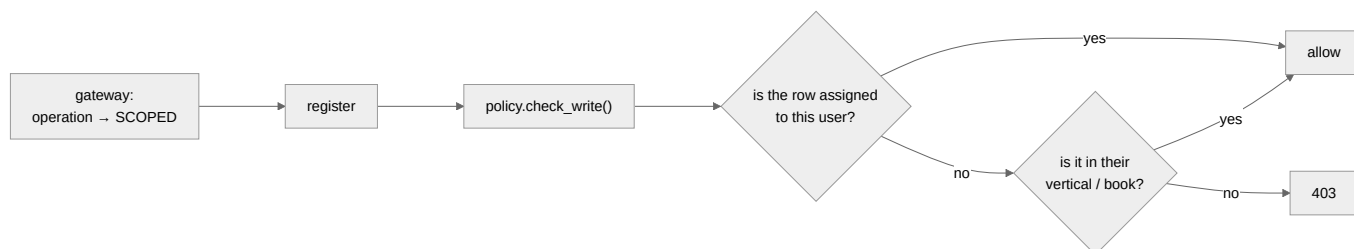
The full operation list, grouped:

Group	Operations
Views	today dashboard leads deals lending syndication asset_monetisation fi_master clients employees audit activity_log tools
Leads	add_lead edit_lead reassign_lead push_lead_to_deals
Clients	create_client edit_client edit_contract edit_intel edit_monitoring add_company_note
Deals	edit_deal_profile edit_deal_ownership add_product_line
Lending	assign_analyst_lending change_lending_stage edit_lending_line
Syndication	assign_analyst_syndication assign_syn_rm edit_syndication_line add_lender_to_mandate log_chase log_response advance_matrix_cell
Asset Mon	assign_analyst_am assign_am_rm edit_am_record
Shared	log_interaction edit_fi_record edit_employee add_employee_assign_role manage_counterparty manage_checklist upload_remove_documents snooze_today_item export_csv
Governance	request_stage_change approve_stage_change delete_row backup_restore
Evidence	attach_committee_evidence attach_sanction_evidence attach_document_evidence attach_qualification_evidence attach_syndication_evidence attach_am_evidence attach_advaya_evidence
Handover / CP-CS	prepare_cpcs_checklist approve_cpcs_checklist initiate_advaya_handover record_handover_package approve_advaya_handover
Servicing	record_ledger_entry authorize_loan_account manage_covenants manage_ews
Intel	run_news_scan

4. What `SCOPED` actually means

`FULL` and `NONE` are self-explanatory. `SCOPED` is the interesting one: **read-write on rows in the user's own scope** — their book, their vertical, or rows explicitly assigned to them.

`SCOPED` is *not* resolved at the gateway. The gateway forwards `X-Authz-Decision: SCOPED` and the **Register** decides which rows qualify, using the central scope evaluator in `packages/evam-backend-core/evam_backend_core/policy.py` against `line_assignments`.



There is exactly one implementation of this. If you find scope logic re-derived in a service, that is a bug — it will drift.

5. The policy engine — three rules beyond RBAC

`policy.py` layers **business-lifecycle** rules on top of role permissions. Having the right role is necessary, not sufficient.

Rule	Meaning	Example
Transitions	Which stage moves are legal (<code>ALLOWED_TRANSITIONS</code>)	<code>IM in Prep -> IM Circulated</code> yes; <code>IM in Prep -> Sanctioned</code> 422
Mandatory fields for a stage (<code>MANDATORY_FOR_STAGE</code>)	A row may not enter a stage until that stage's required fields are present	Lending at <code>Disbursed</code> or <code>Ready for Disbursement</code> requires <code>proposed_disbursement_amount</code> and <code>proposed_disbursement_date</code>
Role/stage field locks (<code>FIELD_LOCKS</code> , <code>ROW_LOCKS</code>)	At a given stage, a field may be edited only by listed roles	A sanctioned amount is frozen except for Admin/Management
Evidence gates (<code>EVIDENCE_FOR_STAGE</code>)	Some stages require workflow-generated evidence on file	Committee outcome, document completeness, CP/CS

Plus the entry rules: **vocabulary is closed** (`STAGE_VOCAB` — free text is rejected) and **birth states are restricted** (`INITIAL_STATUS`).

6. The Access service

`services/access/` — the only service besides the Register that owns data.

Tables

Table	Contents
<code>tenants</code>	Tenant registry
<code>users</code>	People: email, name, active flag
<code>user_roles</code>	Which roles a person holds
<code>access_grants</code>	The runtime authority — the live matrix cells
<code>matrix_versions</code>	Version stamp for the effective matrix
<code>access_audit</code>	Every change to the above

API

Endpoint	Purpose
<code>POST /v1/users</code>	Create a user
<code>GET /v1/users</code> · <code>GET /v1/users/{id}</code>	List / read
<code>PATCH /v1/users/{id}</code>	Update (name, active)
<code>POST /v1/users/{id}/roles</code>	Grant a role
<code>DELETE /v1/users/{id}/roles/{role}</code>	Revoke a role
<code>GET /v1/access</code>	The live matrix
<code>PATCH /v1/access</code>	Edit a matrix cell (governed, audited)
<code>GET /v1/access/drift</code>	Live matrix vs the compiled baseline
<code>GET /v1/access/version</code>	Effective matrix version
<code>GET /v1/resolve</code>	What the gateway calls — roles + effective permissions for an email
<code>GET /v1/me</code>	The caller's own resolved access

Reached through the gateway at `/access/...`, so the browser never holds Access's key.

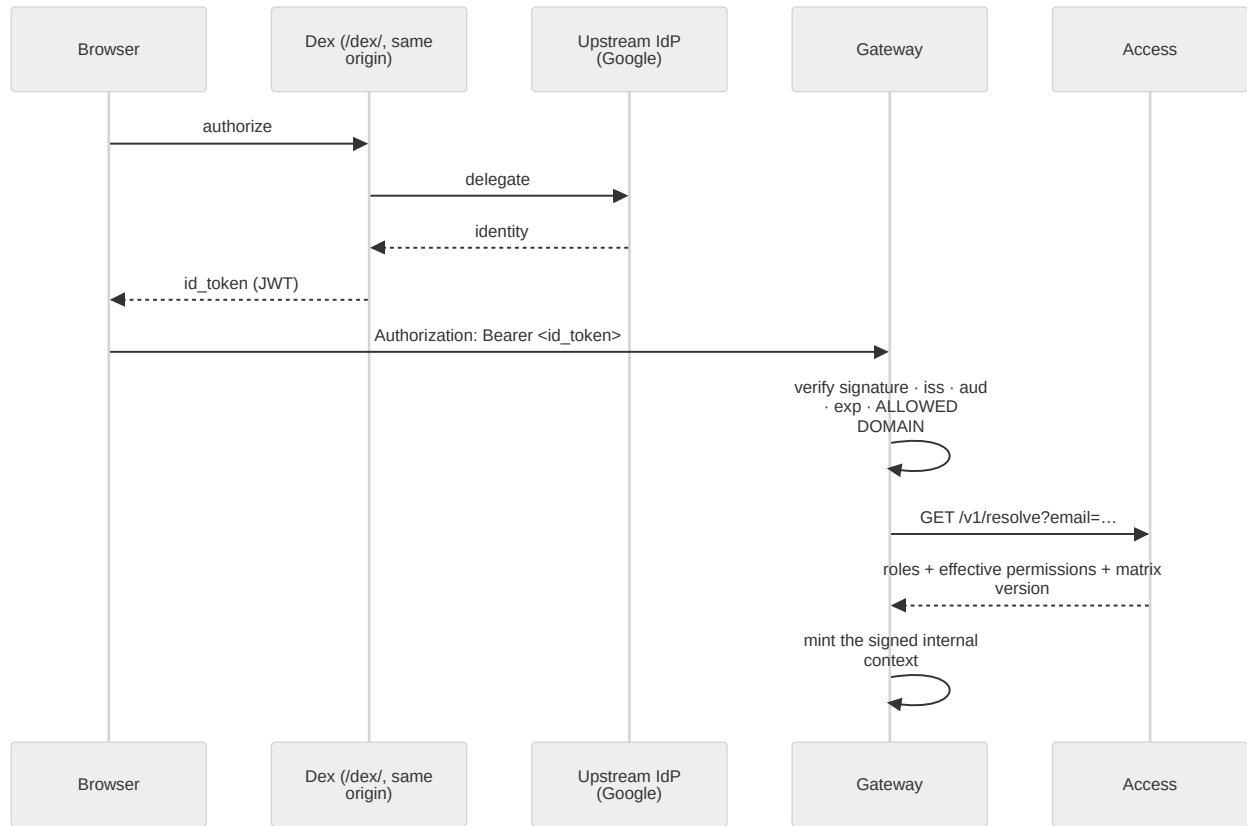
Seeding and drift

```
# Report only – compare the live matrix against the approved baseline. Writes nothing.
docker compose exec access python -m app.seed --check

# Apply: insert MISSING baseline cells, provenance-tagged. Never overwrites a runtime override.
docker compose exec access python -m app.seed
```

In production posture `ACCESS_AUTO_SEED=false`: a container start **never** writes to a non-empty identity database — it prints the drift report instead. The one exception is a completely empty database, where first boot bootstraps tenant + matrix + admin user so a fresh stack is usable rather than bricked.

7. Identity: sign-in and OIDC



PRISM stores no passwords. Dex is a dev IdP — for a real deployment point the issuer at Entra ID, Okta or Keycloak and delete the `dex` service; nothing else changes.

`GATEWAY_OIDC_ALLOWED_DOMAINS` is not optional with a consumer IdP

From `docker-compose.prod-posture.yml`:

"Empty = no restriction, which is fine while Dex is the only issuer (it holds just your own accounts) but MUST be set once a consumer IdP such as Google is accepted — a valid Google token proves the account is real, not that it belongs to Evam."

Evam production sets `evamfinance.com`.

A verified token is not a grant

Authentication and authorization are separate. A person with a valid `@evamfinance.com` token but no roles in `access_grants` can sign in and see nothing. Provisioning is a deliberate second step.

8. Provisioning a person — the runbook

Through ATLAS (normal path)

1. Sign in as **Admin**.
2. **Masters** → **Employees** → **Add / Edit**.

3. Set the person's email (must match their IdP identity exactly) and select one or more roles from the multi-select.
4. Save. The UI calls `accessService.setRoles(...)`, which is `POST /access/v1/users/{id}/roles` and `DELETE .../roles/{role}` under the covers.
5. The person signs out and in, or waits for the permission cache TTL (30 s by default).

If a role change appears not to take

This has happened, and the causes are worth listing:

Cause	Symptom	Fix
The employee row was not backed by an Access user	Save appears to succeed, nothing changes	Fixed in <code>employeesService.ts</code> — a role change that does not apply now throws rather than silently returning
The role list in the dialog was hardcoded and stale	A valid role is missing from the dropdown	Fixed — the dialog now imports <code>ROLES</code> from <code>auth/rbac.ts</code>
Permission cache	Change is correct but not visible yet	Wait the TTL, or <code>POST /atlas/cache/invalidate</code>
Email mismatch with the IdP	The person signs in as a <i>different</i> identity with no grants	Correct the email on the user record

The general lesson, and a rule for this codebase: **a save path must never return silently when it cannot do what was asked**. Report the failure.

Through the API

```
# Create the user
curl -X POST https://<host>/access/v1/users \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
  -d '{"email":"someone@evamfinance.com","full_name":"Someone"}'

# Grant a role
curl -X POST https://<host>/access/v1/users/$USER_ID/roles \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
  -d '{"role":"Management"}'

# Revoke
curl -X DELETE https://<host>/access/v1/users/$USER_ID/roles/BDRM \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer $TOKEN"
```

Deactivating someone

Set the user inactive (`PATCH /v1/users/{id}`) **and** revoke their IdP account. With `REGISTER_ONLINE_REVALIDATION=true`, sensitive operations revalidate against Access online, so the revocation bites immediately for deletes, assignments, governed imports and evidence break-glass. Ordinary reads may still work until the signed context expires (seconds to minutes) and the permission cache turns over.

9. Machine identities

Humans are not the only callers. Service principals are defined in **code** (`service_policy.py`), least-privilege, and widened only by pull request:

Principal	May do
<code>svc_pulse</code>	<code>run_news_scan</code> , <code>edit_intel</code>
<code>svc_vox</code>	<code>create_client</code> , <code>add_lead</code> , <code>edit_lead</code> , <code>log_interaction</code> , <code>add_company_note</code> , <code>add_employee_assign_role</code>
<code>svc_workflows</code>	the above plus <code>push_lead_to_deals</code> , <code>add_product_line</code> , the evidence-attachment verbs, <code>prepare_cpcs_checklist</code> , <code>approve_cpcs_checklist</code> , <code>record_handover_package</code> , <code>approve_advaya_handover</code> , <code>manage_covenants</code> , <code>manage_ews</code>

`attach_advaya_evidence` is deliberately **absent** from `svc_workflows` — it is granted only under an enabled Advaya integration (default off), so the dormant acknowledgement path is not executable in a normal deployment. That is a fabricated-acknowledgement defence, and it should stay that way.

A generic (unnamed) API key keeps legacy behaviour governed by `enforce_rbac`; in production posture `REGISTER_ENFORCE_RBAC=true` means a bare key can no longer act at all.

10. Tenant isolation

Two independent mechanisms, both required:

1. **Application scoping** — every query carries the tenant, resolved from `X-Tenant` or the signed context.
2. **PostgreSQL row-level security** — with `REGISTER_ENFORCE_RLS=true`, RLS policies are applied *and force-converged at startup*. A query cannot leave its tenant even if application code forgets a filter.

RLS is **fail-closed**: if the policy cannot be established, the service refuses to serve rather than serving everything.

11. Auditing

Question	Where
Who changed a role or a matrix cell?	<code>access_audit</code> (Access service)
Who changed a business record?	The Register's audit trail; ATLAS Activity and Audit tabs (Admin-only)
Who approved a workflow decision?	<code>workflow_decisions</code> — the single-winner durable record, naming the decider, their roles and the note
Under which policy version was a decision made?	<code>policy_version</code> claim, stamped into every signed context and on seeds and drift reports

That last one is the point of `POLICY_VERSION`: an authorization decision can always answer “*under which policy?*”

12. Changing authorization — a checklist

- ☐ Is this a **runtime** grant (a person's roles, a matrix cell)? → Admin does it through Access. No deploy.
- ☐ Is this a **new role** or a **new operation**? → `rbac_catalog.py` / `rbac.py`, plus the UI mirror in `auth/rbac.ts`, plus a seed + drift check.
- ☐ Does a **machine** need it? → `service_policy.py`, reviewed.
- ☐ Is it a **route** that should be gated at the door? → `services/gateway/app/routes_map.py`.
- ☐ Is it a **lifecycle** rule (legal moves, mandatory fields, locks)? → `lifecycle.py` / `policy.py`, not RBAC.
- ☐ Did you bump `POLICY_VERSION` if the compiled baseline changed?
- ☐ Does the front-end mirror still match? The UI copy in `auth/rbac.ts` is a *mirror*, not the authority — but a drifted mirror shows people buttons that will 403.